

Module Production Guide

This guide is intended to support the development of new or the revision of existing modules. While it provides general guidance, it may not address all specific questions or concerns. Therefore, it is strongly recommended that tutors maintain ongoing communication with the production team to ensure that particular needs and issues are effectively identified as soon as they arise and therefore, can be resolved.

Project Details

Project Goal

To record and edit lecture content developed by academics to create high-quality learning materials for higher education. The aim is to give students an engaging and smooth learning experience.

Project Scope

The project includes recording and editing academic lectures quickly and efficiently. The production team will work closely with academics to ensure the content is correct and meets agreed standards for educational videos.

Project Timeline

The project will take approximately **4 to 7 months**. The exact time depends on the size of the module, whether it's the first time working together on a module, and how tailored the content needs to be.

Roles and Responsibilities

Academic Team

Programme Manager (PM)

Leads the development of the module, coordinating efforts across teams and supporting Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) with content and structure. While the PM may not be a subject matter expert in all areas, SMEs are encouraged to contribute their own expertise where appropriate. Regular check-ins are held to monitor progress and provide ongoing guidance.

Although the PM is not formally the SME's line manager, it is expected that reasonable requests and recommendations made by the PM will be followed in the spirit of collaboration. If any concerns arise, SME should communicate these with their line manager at the earliest opportunity.

Subject Matter Expert (SME)

The SME acts as the module lecturer, responsible for creating core learning materials, formative and summative assessments, and recommending supporting resources. Following the agreed timeline is essential. Any delays must be

communicated promptly to the PM and Project Manager to allow for adjustments and support.

SMEs are expected to adhere strictly to the Definitive Module Record (DMR), including any approved amendments. If there is uncertainty about which version of the DMR to follow, please consult the PM for clarification.

The module syllabus must be discussed in detail with the PM to ensure proper sequencing of content and to avoid duplication across modules. This collaborative planning is essential to maintain coherence within the programme.

To assist with content creation, SMEs will be provided with previous presentation slides where available. Additionally, the PM will supply clear guidance on required updates, including any new content that needs to be incorporated. While following these guidelines, SMEs are encouraged to apply their academic and professional expertise to enrich the TLP.

Production Team

Project Manager

Leads the project within Production Team, managing the team, workflow, and ensuring quality, risk, and change are effectively handled. Responsible for updating plans, communicating changes and progress to stakeholders, and addressing any issues promptly.

Audio Recorder

Works with the academic during voiceover sessions to ensure the audio is professionally recorded, clean, clear, and high quality.

Greenscreen Crew

Includes a Camera Operator and Script Supervisor who manage the video recording of lecture segments filmed on greenscreen.

Video Editor

Produces and edits the visual content for lectures, combining it with audio to create polished video materials.

TLP Creator

Builds a bespoke TLP for the module, ensuring it is structured, functional, and user-friendly.

Transcript Editor

Edits transcripts after recording for clarity and accessibility, and prepares them for integration into the Total Learning Package (TLP)

Quality Control

Reviews all final materials before release to students. Both academic and production staff share responsibility for this stage.

Production Phases

Phase 1: Pre-Production

In this phase, the SME meets with the Project Manager (PM) to plan the creation of the module. During this meeting, they discuss and decide:

- Syllabus and lecture content
- The production process, including recording and quality control
- Key deadlines, creating a timeline based on the module's start date
- Deadlines for deliverables

The SME is expected to provide the following deliverables before the next phase:

- Module syllabus
- Transcripts
- PowerPoints
- Formative assessments
- Summative assessments
- Core and supporting reading

Phase 2: Production

In this phase, the Subject Matter Expert (SME) or another academic colleague if agreed works with the production team to record the lecture content. This includes both voiceover and on-camera video segments, following a standardised process to ensure consistency and quality.

Key activities include:

- Recording voiceovers in the studio, reading from transcripts on-screen
- Filming video segments with the greenscreen team, using a teleprompter
- Support from the production team throughout to assist with any questions or issues.

Phase 3: Post-Production

In this phase, the production team transforms the recorded materials into polished, accessible learning content. This involves editing, enhancing, and assembling all elements to create high-quality video lectures, ready for delivery on the learning platform.

Key tasks include:

- Editing raw audio and video recordings
- Designing graphics or additional visual content as needed
- Assembling and finalising the full lecture videos
- Building the module within the Teaching and Learning Platform (TLP)
- Formatting transcripts and adding closed captions to ensure accessibility

Phase 4: Review

Before the module is launched, the Production Team, PM and Subject Matter Expert (SME) review all lecture materials.

Final videos are shared via Frame.io, where the SME can leave feedback (e.g. corrections to titles, spelling, or data). Reviews must be completed within **2 weeks** to allow time for final edits before uploading to the Total Learning Package (TLP).

Phase 5: Project Closure

Once all deliverables have been completed and accepted by the stakeholders, the module will be implemented and the Project Manager will conduct a project review to identify lessons learned and best practices, ensuring that any project documentation is properly archived.

Deliverables

The SMEs must deliver the following:

- Module structure (1 month before transcripts and PowerPoints)
- Transcripts (2 weeks before recording)
- PowerPoints (2 weeks before recording)
- Core and supporting reading materials (2 weeks before recording)
- All audio and video must be recorded **two months** before the module is released.
- Review video content (1 month before module start date)
- Here is an example workflow of when **SMEs must submit deliverables** to the production team. This is based on starting the creation of a module in February for a September start.

Deliverable	Feb	Mar	Apr	Jun	July	Aug	Sept
Module inception							
Module structure							
Supporting materials							
PowerPoints							
Transcripts							
All content recorded							
Review edited materials							
Module released							

Module Structure

The module structure consists of **chapters** and **lectures**.

- Each chapter should have a clear and short title and subject, closely aligned to module learning outcomes.
- All lectures within a chapter must relate to that subject area and agreed syllabus.
- Use the production sheet to complete your module structure (see example provided).

[screenshot of filled out spreadsheet]

Recommended Structure

The number of lectures per chapter can be adjusted to suit the content, but try to keep it consistent for pacing and learner experience. We recommend:

- 5 chapters, each with **5-6 lectures**
- Each lecture should be not more than **20 minutes**
- This results in a total of **500–600 minutes** of video content
- An introduction and conclusion must be included at the beginning and end of the module. Introduction should include overview of module learning outcomes and structure of the module/TLP. Conclusion should explain how learning outcomes have been delivered.

If you're unsure or facing challenges with structuring the module, please discuss it with the Production team.

Chapter and Lecture Titles

There are some conventions required for chapter and lecture titles:

- Titles must be distinctive from each other
- Written in title case
- Written in British English
- Chapter title length: 5 words or less
- Lecture title length: under 50 characters, including spaces.

Following these conventions makes a more accessible learning experience, with clear navigation and distinction between content.

Module Content

Each module should begin with a clear explanation of the intended learning outcomes, outlining what students are expected to achieve by the end of the module and how the content and assessments are designed to support these outcomes. This helps students understand the purpose and relevance of each component of the TLP. Similarly, the conclusion of the module should include a review of the learning outcomes, highlighting how each has been addressed throughout the course.

This structured approach should also be applied at the lecture level. Each lecture should begin with a brief introduction to the specific learning outcome(s) it addresses, and conclude with a summary that reinforces how the content supports the achievement of those outcomes.

Formative Assessment

It is recommended to include at least one formative assessment per chapter or per learning outcome. However, variations to this approach are acceptable and should be discussed with the PM during your regular catch-up meetings.

Formative assessments should aim to engage students in a variety of ways. These may include reflective tasks (e.g. *“How do these developments impact your current role or future career progression?”*), as well as short quizzes or other interactive elements. Wherever possible, assessments should be designed to be self-checking, enabling students to monitor their own progress and learn independently.

If you believe that tutor involvement is necessary for reviewing a particular formative task, this can be arranged. However, in such cases, the activity should be closely aligned with the intended learning outcomes to justify the need for tutor input.

Summative Assessment

If your module includes more than one assessment submission, it is essential to ensure that the assessments and accompanying learning materials are properly sequenced. For example, if students are required to submit a presentation early in the module, the assessment should be clearly linked to the learning outcomes addressed in the initial chapters or videos.

This alignment should be made explicit to students by referencing the relevant learning outcomes and/or specific chapters and video content. Clear connections between assessments and learning materials will help students understand expectations and allow them to prepare effectively.

SMEs are required to prepare two assessment documents, along with one referral (resit) assessment. This approach ensures that tutors have access to a bank of assessment materials as they become familiar with the content and structure of the

module. It also provides valuable support during the initial deliveries of the module, helping to maintain consistency and academic integrity across assessment periods.

Supporting Materials

As part of the development of the TLP, you will need to provide a comprehensive list of supporting materials required for your module. We strongly encourage you to categorise these into two sections:

- Core texts: required readings that students must engage with to meet the learning outcomes.
- Further reading: recommended texts or resources for students who wish to explore topics in greater depth.

All listed resources should ideally be accessible through University of Plymouth library Primo. Where access through Primo is not possible, please clearly highlight any access restrictions so that alternative arrangements can be considered.

A critical consideration in this process is format: wherever feasible, please source readings as downloadable PDF files to be embedded directly within the TLP. Avoid using links to external websites, which may change or become inaccessible over time.

Please note that all proposed materials will undergo a copyright check. If any issues arise, we may follow up to discuss alternative options.

Deadline

The final version of the content map is required **1 month before any of the other deliverables**, to allow time for the Production team to work on building the structure of the TLP based on the module structure given.

Transcripts

Transcripts are word-for-word scripts of what you'll say during each lecture. They are used for both studio recordings (voiceover and greenscreen) and for closed captions and transcripts in the TLP.

Tone and Style

Write in your natural voice, as if you're speaking to a group of students in person. The tone should be conversational and engaging; this isn't an academic essay. A relaxed style comes across better in recordings and helps learners connect with the content.

Use British English, and if using tools like ChatGPT, be sure to remove American spellings, long dashes, or overly formal phrasing.

Structure and Format

- Transcripts should be approximately **2,000 words per lecture** (based on 100 words ≈ 1 minute of spoken content).
- Submit files in **Microsoft Word format (.doc or .docx)** or a compatible equivalent.
- Structure the transcript using **slide numbers** that correspond with your PowerPoint slides. This helps with navigation and production alignment (see the PowerPoint section for more on this).
- Name each file using the **lecture numbering system**, e.g., 1.5 for Chapter 1, Lecture 5.
- Submit **one transcript per lecture**, and place each into the relevant **production folder**.

Verbatim Accuracy

Transcripts must be **verbatim**, what you plan to say exactly. This ensures consistency for closed captions and production. Small on-the-day edits (e.g. correcting a word) are fine, but major changes to the structure can cause issues across the team and must be avoided.

Before submission, **read your transcript out loud**. This helps you spot any awkward phrasing, structural issues, or inaccuracies, saving time during recording and editing.

Tips and Workflow

You may find it helpful to create your transcript alongside your PowerPoint. Tools like speech-to-text software can be useful: try presenting your content aloud, then refine the text output into a tidy, natural-sounding script. This is just a suggestion, please use whatever method suits your working style, as long as the final deliverables meet the required format and quality.

Deadline

Submit transcripts **at least two weeks before recording begins**. This allows time for formatting, teleprompter setup and greenscreen planning. Tweaks may be made to the transcripts by the Script Supervisor for optimum learning experience.

PowerPoints

The PowerPoints serve as **storyboards** to support the Production Team in editing lecture videos. They are used to align visuals with the voiceover; they are for **internal use only** and will not be used in the final lecture videos.

Purpose and Format

- The content of each slide should show what content should appear during each part of the voiceover
- The slide should correlate with the relevant transcript section (see example).
- No design of the slides required; **focus on content only**.

Text

Text can be used on screen to highlight key terms or important points, supporting the voiceover without overwhelm

- Use **bullet points** – short, clear and keyword-based
- Avoid full sentences, unless they are quotes
- Match phrasing with the transcript
- Use quotes providing they are brief (a few sentences long) and are accurate and **clearly attributed**
- Write in British English
- Check spelling and grammar carefully – the text is copied **directly into the lecture video** so must be accurate

Usage Rules & Permissions (Copyright Materials)

As a private university, our lecture content is considered commercial, so all images, data, and media must be cleared for commercial use.

You can include:

- Original content you've created
- Public domain materials
- Creative Commons content (CC-BY or CC-BY-SA) – must include proper credit

AVOID USING COPYRIGHTED MATERIALS. If there's no alternative and it's essential:

- Request permission **before** the transcript and PowerPoint deadline
- If approved, record it in the copyright spreadsheet
- If not approved, an alternative must be found.

Always check permissions before including any material. **IF UNSURE, CONTACT THE PRODUCTION TEAM BEFORE ADDING IT TO THE SCRIPT OR SLIDES.**

Images and Media

Subject specific images and media add clear context to the message of the transcript, but have requirements before they can be included:

- A high-resolution version must be available (>1000px) so we have a sharp image and avoid blur or pixelation
- Must have the correct permissions in order to include in the lectures.

Data, Graphs and Maps

Data can help illustrate key points, but must be used carefully and legally.

- Consider longevity – choose data that will stay relevant over time
- Check permissions – ensure data is suitable for commercial use and credit if required
- If graphs or maps are restricted but the raw data is not, the Production Team can create our own visuals based on the dataset

Deadline

Submit PowerPoints **at least two weeks before recording begins**. This allows time for the Production Team to collate high-resolution media and plan the video timeline for each lecture.

Other Supporting Materials

If the SME wants to include other materials, they must:

- Discuss the format and how they will be included with the Production Team
- Ensure they follow the permissions guidance.